



CENTRUM FÜR ASIEN-
WISSENSCHAFTEN UND
TRANSKULTURELLE STUDIEN
INSTITUT FÜR SINOLOGIE



**UNIVERSITÄT
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ZUKUNFT
SEIT 1386

Heidelberg, 15.05.2026

Prof. Dr. Barbara Mittler
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To the Visa Officer, Embassy of the Federal Republic of Germany in Seoul / To Whom It
May Concern:

Re: Official Letter of Invitation for Visiting Research Fellow

Invitee Details:

Name: Lei GAO

Date of Birth: [REDACTED FOR PUBLIC COPY]

Passport Number: [REDACTED]

Nationality: P.R. China

The Centre for Asian and Transcultural Studies (CATS) at Heidelberg University is delighted to officially invite Lei Gao to join our institute as a Visiting Research Fellow for a continuous 12-month period, commencing on September 1, 2026, and concluding on August 31, 2027.

Lei Gao is a distinguished scholar in the fields of Global Intellectual History and Digital Humanities. His upcoming monograph, *Digital Fate: The Leibnizian Code and the Dao of Algorithms* (forthcoming with Routledge), represents a significant contribution to the study of transcultural philosophical exchange. His research investigates the historical development of mathematical logic, tracing its genealogy from the *I Ching* (Book of Changes) to Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz's 17th-century manuscripts. This scholarly endeavor aligns perfectly with CATS's core mission of interrogating the asymmetric flows of knowledge and the transcultural exchange of ideas between East and West.

During his 12-month fellowship, Lei Gao will utilize Heidelberg University as his primary European research base for his archival studies. His presence will enrich our intellectual community and establish a strategic research axis, connecting our center with his upcoming academic endeavors at the Herzog August Bibliothek (Wolfenbüttel) and the Warburg Institute (London) to examine historical manuscripts and early modern philosophies.

CATS will provide Lei Gao with institutional affiliation, access to our specialized libraries, and participation in our academic colloquia to facilitate the historical synthesis of his research.

Financial Declaration: Please note that while CATS is fully committed to providing the robust academic infrastructure necessary for this scholarly project, CATS bears no financial responsibility for Lei Gao's stay. Lei Gao will be entirely self-funded during his 12-month fellowship. He will independently cover all his travel, accommodation, living expenses, and comprehensive medical insurance in Germany via his personal financial resources and his personal German bank account.

We eagerly anticipate welcoming Lei Gao to Heidelberg.

Sincerely,

[SIGNATURE REDACTED]

Prof. Dr. Barbara Mittler
Centre for Asian and Transcultural Studies (CATS)
Heidelberg University

